Theme 3: Tourism and Hospitality

Eating Out (Narrative essay)

Lesson 3-5
Book pages 42-43

💡 **Big idea:** We read a mixed-up narrative essay, **'A Nightmare Meal'**, put the paragraphs in order, and learn how a **narrative essay** is organised: a clear introduction, events in **sequence**, and a good ending.

🎯 **I will learn:**

- Analyse the structure of a narrative essay
- Put paragraphs in a logical sequence
- Describe good and bad restaurants
- Plan and write a narrative essay

📖 Key words

narrative قصصي / سردي	**sequence** تسلسل	**atmosphere** جو	**attentive** منتبه ومهتم
cutlery أدوات المائدة	**décor** ديكور	**reasonable prices** أسعار معقولة	**misunderstanding** سوء فهم

Essay organisation

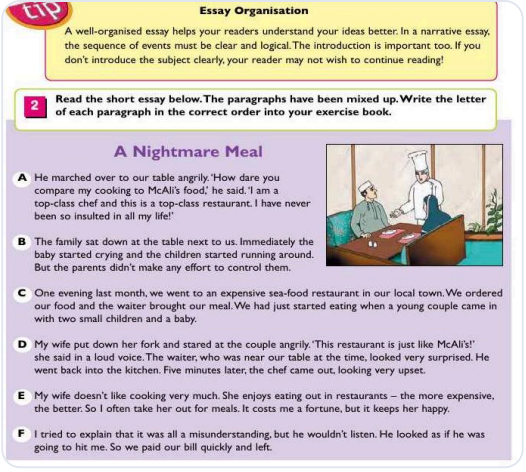
- A well-organised essay helps readers understand your ideas
- In a narrative essay the sequence of events must be clear and logical
- The introduction is important: it makes the reader want to continue
- Use time words: one evening, immediately, five minutes later, then

Good vs bad restaurant

- Good: delicious food, attentive service, varied menu, attractive décor, reasonable prices, cosy atmosphere
- Bad: rude waiters, long wait between courses, dirty cutlery, errors on the bill, tables crowded together

A Nightmare Meal (correct order)

- E (introduction: my wife enjoys eating out) → C (one evening at an expensive seafood restaurant) → B (a noisy family sat next to us) → D (my wife compared the food to McAli's) → A (the angry chef came over) → F (we paid quickly and left)



Essay Organisation

A well-organised essay helps your readers understand your ideas better. In a narrative essay, the sequence of events must be clear and logical. The introduction is important too. If you don't introduce the subject clearly, your reader may not wish to continue reading!

2 **Read the short essay below. The paragraphs have been mixed up. Write the letter of each paragraph in the correct order into your exercise book.**

A Nightmare Meal

A He marched over to our table angrily. 'How dare you compare my cooking to McAli's food,' he said. 'I am a top-class chef and this is a top-class restaurant. I have never been so insulted in all my life!'

B The family sat down at the table next to us. Immediately the baby started crying and the children started running around. But the parents didn't make any effort to control them.

C One evening last month, we went to an expensive sea-food restaurant in our local town. We ordered our food and the waiter brought our meal. We had just started eating when a young couple came in with two small children and a baby.

D My wife put down her fork and stared at the couple angrily. 'This restaurant is just like McAli's!' she said in a loud voice. The waiter, who was near our table at the time, looked very surprised. He went back into the kitchen. Five minutes later, the chef came out, looking very upset.

E My wife doesn't like cooking very much. She enjoys eating out in restaurants – the more expensive, the better. So I often take her out for meals. It costs me a fortune, but it keeps her happy.

F I tried to explain that it was all a misunderstanding, but he wouldn't listen. He looked as if he was going to hit me. So we paid our bill quickly and left.

Essay organisation and 'A Nightmare Meal' (p.42)

✏️ Examples

Give a sequencing expression to start a story.

Answer: One evening last month, ...

Write one sentence describing a good restaurant.

Answer: The waiters were attentive and the atmosphere was warm and friendly.

⭐ Remember

- Plan before writing: introduction → events in order → ending (result or feeling).

⚠️ Watch out

- ✗ jumping between events without time words ✓ use sequencing words to show order

🧩 **Activity:** Write a short narrative essay about the best or worst meal you have had, with a suitable title.

✅ Check yourself

1. Most important feature of a narrative essay?
2. Two features of a bad restaurant
3. Which paragraph comes first?
4. Meaning of 'attentive'?

Answers: (1) a clear and logical sequence of events ، (2) rude waiters, dirty cutlery ، (3) E ، (4) paying close attention, helpful